

The gentle giant

Meet the largest animal alive today—the blue whale. This animal is so large that a bull elephant (the largest living land animal) could sit on its tongue. Other whales look tiny by comparison.

Blue whale facts

- Blue whales have been known to reach the age of 80.
- An adult blue whale is protected by a layer of blubber that, in places, is as thick as an open page from this book.
- The whale can swim 10 times faster than you can walk.

How big?

Everything about this whale is big. Its flippers would stretch from the floor to the ceiling of your bedroom, while its heart is the size of a small car.



What a whopper!

At birth a blue whale is more than a thousand times heavier than a human baby. It will guzzle about 50 gallons (200 liters) of its mother's milk every day. It needs to. It puts on the equivalent in weight of six five-year-old children each day!

The blue whale can grow to